

"I don't differentiate between film music and independent music"

SANTHOSH NARAYANAN, 38

Film composer and musician, Tamil Nadu

DREAM CATCHER

Santhosh Narayanan, who made his debut in 2012 with the Pa. Ranjith-directed *Attakathi*, can easily be termed as a musician of the past decade. *Attakathi*, a trendsetter of sorts, was a debutant movie for Pa. Ranjith too; while he presented it with a new aesthetic and ideology that centred around marginalised people, Santhosh impressed everyone with his romantic melody and peppy *Ghana* (ethnic music of north Chennai) songs. He continued impressing in his subsequent films, and new directors with creative ideas clung to him. If Ranjith took him to the alleys of north Chennai, Karthik Subburaj made him travel the streets of Madurai and Mari Selvaraj made him feel the heat of Tirunelveli. Santhosh got into the skin of each genre. His song, 'Nerupuda', in the movie *Kabali*, starring Rajinikanth is the only song that has reflected the superstar's mass appeal in recent years. Any young director who enters Tamil cinema with the dream of changing it can bank on Santhosh to render his or her vision into music for the soul. ■

– Naveen Rajan

CAREFUL AND CAUTIOUS He is always anxious about the response to his works, but is particularly worried about the opinions of his mother Mahalakshmi and wife Meenakshi, both of whom are well-versed in music

